ATENEO DE NAGA UNIVERSITY
NAGA CITY

HONORING HERITAGE:

The Carahan Festival's Impact on Caramoan Culture and Society

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in partial fulfillment of the requirements
for the subject
SOCS102 N6

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ABSTRACT

Festivals celebrate a community's traditions, values, and identity. This study explores the impact of the Isla Carahan Festival on cultural identity and social cohesion in Caramoan, Camarines Sur. It addresses three questions: 1) How does the festival contribute to preserving customs, fostering community involvement, and strengthening a collective sense of identity? 2) How does participation create a sense of belonging and cultural pride? 3) How can the festival balance modernization and cultural preservation? Held annually from May 6 to May 8, the festival highlights local cuisine, environmental activities, and community traditions. A qualitative descriptive approach was used, gathering data through surveys and interviews with residents living in Caramoan for at least five years. Thematic analysis, involving six steps—data familiarization, coding, theme identification, review, definition, and reporting—was employed (Georgiou Konstantinos, 2024). Findings show that the Carahan Festival enhances cultural pride, preserves heritage, and fosters unity while boosting tourism and local economies. Challenges such as commercialization and maintaining authenticity were also identified. This study underscores the festival's role in preserving traditions, strengthening community bonds, and guiding sustainable practices that balance modern demands with cultural heritage conservation.

Keywords: Carahan Festival, cultural identity, social cohesion, community traditions, heritage preservation, modernization, commercialization, cultural authenticity, thematic analysis, Caramoan, sustainable cultural practices, tourism impact, local economy, community involvement.

CHAPTER ONE

Background of the Study

Festivals are the celebration of a culture, its values, traditions, and uniqueness. The cause for festival celebrations is not limited to these categories; they can include religion, art, and history. There are numerous festivals celebrated around the world today, each having their own reasons for celebration. The Day of the Dead in Mexico, which honors dead loved ones as well as accepting death as a possibility and handling it with familiarity (Britannica 2006).[1] Carnevale in Italy, where people celebrate for several weekends beginning around a month before Ash Wednesday, complete with sweeping parades, intricate masks, and an abundance of colorful confetti (Mussio 2020).[2] These celebrations bring people within and outside of a community together. A study found that festivals provide both cultural and economic benefits to a community, as well as preservation of the local traditions (Gonzales 2017).

There are countless festivals celebrated in the Philippines, coming from different regions, municipalities, cities, and even barangays. In the Bicol region, there are numerous festivals celebrated every month from various locations. In April Masbate, Sañgay in Camarines Sur and Donsol in Sorsogon celebrate the Rodeo festival, Baybayon festival, and Butanding festival, respectively. There are around fifteen well-known festivals celebrated throughout the Bicol Region ("Events and Festivals—CITY of Naga" 2022).[3]

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[1] Britannica, *"Day of the Dead | Mexican Tradition, Celebrations & Rituals.*
[2] Mussio, C*arnevale in Italy: What It Is and Where to Celebrate | Ciao Andiamo.*
[3] Naga Gov PH, *Events and Festivals – CITY of NAGA*

The Isla Carahan Festival is celebrated in Caramoan, Camarines Sur, and lasts from May 6 to May 8. The celebration showcases the community's culture, indigenous industry, and beauty. The highlighted events are the showcase of the local cuisine, a tree-planting ceremony, a fun run, and a float competition (Philippine Daily Inquirer 2018).[4]

Many researchers have already conducted studies on festivals as well as their effects on culture and economy, but only a few study their impact on the community's sense of identity and cultural unity. Studies have discussed the benefits of holding celebrations in urban areas and local governments (Gonzales 2017), the socio-cultural effects of festivals (Magpantay et al. 2014), and the different festivals in certain areas and their evolution (Palma et al. 2023).[5][6] The researchers realized the need to investigate the effects of the festivals on a community's sense of identity and cultural unity.

[4] Inquirer.Net, *This Week's Festivals: May 6-12, 2018*
[5] Magpantay et al., *Socio-Cultural Effects of Festivals in Batangas Province, Philippines." Asia Pacific Journal of Education, Arts and Sciences*
[6] Palma et al., *Historical Evolution of Festivals in Guimaras Island, Philippines: Its Implication to Tourism Industry Growth.*

Statement of the Problem

This study aims to explore the role of the Carahan Festival in strengthening the sense of cultural identity and community cohesion among the residents of Caramoan, Camarines Sur. For the participation in the festival is not solely an expression of tradition but a reflection of community bonds and shared heritage that foster cultural unity. Specifically, it seeks to address the following questions:

1. How does the Carahan Festival contribute to preserving local customs, fostering community involvement, and strengthening a collective sense of identity?

2. How does participation in the festival create a sense of belonging and cultural pride among Caramoan residents?

3. In what ways can the festival balance modernization and commercialization with the preservation of its authentic cultural aspects?

Scope and Delimitations

This study's inclusion criteria required the respondents to be a resident of Caramoan, Camarines Sur. The respondents must be a resident for at least 5 years. Respondents from any age bracket were accepted to participate in this study. This study excluded non-permanent residents of the area.

Significance of the Study

This study aims to assess the festival's impact on both the cultural and social dimensions of Caramoan, with particular attention to how it contributes to the preservation of local customs, economic development, and social cohesion.

Cultural Preservation and Promotion. Understanding the mechanisms by which the festival fosters cultural pride and awareness can inform future efforts to protect and promote indigenous practices and traditions in an increasingly globalized world.

Local Government Units (LGUs). The study's findings are particularly significant for the Local Government Unit (LGU) of Caramoan. Understanding the multifaceted impacts of the Carahan Festival will assist the LGU in making informed decisions regarding festival management, funding, and promotion. The study will also be beneficial for the LGU in fostering partnerships with local businesses, cultural organizations, and other stakeholders to ensure that the festival continues to thrive and benefit the local community. They bolster the alliance's position and influence within the field of economic development.

Community. Beyond its cultural and economic impact, the Carahan Festival plays a crucial role in fostering social cohesion with Caramoan. The research will explore how the festival promotes community participation, collective identity, and solidarity among residents. The study will assess the festival's role in building a sense of unity and pride, as well as its capacity to address social issues by encouraging collaboration and mutual understanding among community members.

Future Researchers. This study provides a valuable resource for upcoming researchers who wish to delve into similar topics such as cultural festivals, tourism, and community development in the Philippines. Its in-depth analysis, data, and insights establish a solid foundation for future investigations and a more nuanced understanding of the role of cultural festivals in local development.

Definition of Terms

The researchers describe the following terminologies according to how they are used in this research to have a better and more accurate explanation for the readers:

Carahan: This research will define Carahan as the celebration of the beauty and bounty of Caramoan Island, highlighting its industry and cultural heritage.

Festival: This research will define Festival as a public celebration that highlights a community's cultural, historical or religious heritage, often through activities and other cultural displays.

CHAPTER TWO

Review of Related Literature

Festivals' Cultural Contribution

Festivals have long been recognized for their cultural significance, as they showcase and preserve a community's heritage and values. These events often include a variety of activities that reflect local customs and traditions. According to Skoultsos (2014), modern festivals, including those in Caramoan, now incorporate art forms like music and dance, which not only revive regional traditions but also promote them to a wider audience[7]. The Isla Carahan Festival, for instance, highlights local cuisine, indigenous arts, and environmental activities, demonstrating how festivals can integrate modern aspects to engage different audiences while preserving traditional values ("Caramoan Tourism," PeoPlaid, 2023).[8] Such celebrations foster a sense of pride and unity, contributing to the strengthening of local identity, especially as the world becomes more interconnected and influenced by global trends.

Cultural festivals also offer an avenue for showcasing intangible heritage, such as local customs and rituals, which are experiential and cease to exist once the event concludes. Barrio, Devesa, and Herrero (2012) argue that these festivals serve as platforms for the preservation and revitalization of intangible cultural heritage, blending historical practices with contemporary expressions.[9] The Isla Carahan Festival embodies this concept by incorporating both traditional and modern elements, allowing the community to engage with their heritage while also reaching a broader, contemporary audience.

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[7] Skoultsos, *Greek Economic Outlook,* 61-66.
[8] Pleopaid, *Caramoan Tourism.*
[9] Barrio, Devesa & Herrero, *Evaluating Intangible Cultural Heritage.*

Festivals and Identity

The role of festivals in shaping collective identity is critical, as they serve as a reflection of a community's unique cultural practices. Festivals are not only a means of preserving and passing down traditions to future generations but also a way for communities to express pride and belonging. Jaeger and Mykletun (2013) suggest that festivals are instrumental in strengthening the sense of identity and unity within a community.[10] The Isla Carahan Festival, with its inclusion of traditional practices such as tree-planting ceremonies and food showcases, provides opportunities for residents to connect with their heritage, reinforcing their cultural pride and sense of belonging.

Additionally, the location of festivals plays an important role in defining a community's identity. Urban centers often host large festivals to attract diverse audiences, contributing not only to cultural pride but also to the local economy through increased tourism. Finkel and Platt (2020) discuss how cultural festivals serve as catalysts for tourism and socio-economic development in host cities.[11] This is evident in the Isla Carahan Festival, where the region's natural beauty and rich traditions attract visitors, further solidifying Caramoan's position as a cultural hub. Gonzalez-Reverte (2023) highlights that the selection of festival locations is integral to reinforcing local identity, as the spatial dynamics of the event help shape the public perception of the community's heritage.[12]

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[10] Jaeger & Mykletun, *Festivals, Identities and Belonging,* 213-216
[11] Finkel & Platt, *Cultural Festivals and the City. "Geography Compass".*
[12] Gonzalez-Reverte, Space, *Identity and Festivals." Journal of Heritage Tourism"*

Modernization's Role in Festivals

While festivals remain deeply rooted in tradition, modernization has transformed their structure and presentation. The introduction of digital marketing, social media, and live streaming has expanded the reach of festivals like the Isla Carahan Festival, enabling them to engage larger and more diverse audiences. However, Finkel and Platt (2020) caution that modernization may lead to commercialization, which can dilute the authentic cultural essence of the festival. Nonetheless, Gonzalez-Reverte (2023) observes that modernization also offers opportunities to document and share cultural traditions, ensuring their survival and global recognition, even as festivals evolve to meet modern expectations.

Economic and Tourism Impacts

Festivals, particularly those with a strong cultural focus, are also significant contributors to local economies. Through increased tourism and participation, they provide financial benefits to local businesses, foster cultural exchange, and support the development of tourism infrastructure. The Isla Carahan Festival plays a vital role in attracting visitors to Caramoan, enhancing its economic standing by drawing attention to its natural attractions and local culture ("Caramoan Tourism," PeoPlaid, 2023).[13] This cultural exchange is essential in reinforcing Caramoan's reputation as a cultural and tourist destination, demonstrating the positive impact that well-managed festivals can have on local economies.

[13] Pleopaid, *Caramoan Tourism.*

Intangible Heritage and Modern Applications

The relationship between festivals and intangible heritage is central to the conversation about cultural preservation in the face of modernization. Barrio, Devesa, and Herrero (2012) highlight that festivals are living examples of intangible cultural heritage, as they continuously adapt to the changing times while retaining core traditional elements.[14] The Isla Carahan Festival exemplifies this concept by integrating contemporary activities into its traditional framework, ensuring that the festival remains relevant and engaging for new generations without compromising its cultural integrity.

[14] Barrio, Devesa & Herrero, *Evaluating Intangible Cultural Heritage.*

CHAPTER THREE

Discussion

Research Design

This study utilized a qualitative-nonexperimental design using a descriptive technique of the variables involved through the results of the gathered data. Qualitative research, as defined by Europe PMC (2016), asks open-ended questions like "how" and "why," which are difficult to quantify in order to congregate the participant's behavior, experiences, attitudes, and perception. The ability to explain human behavior and its processes and patterns is one of the advantages of qualitative research. Descriptive research studies events or individuals as they are in nature with the aims of describing and understanding these variables. Although it doesn't establish causality, it aids in analyzing relationships between variables (Siedlecki 2019). This technique observes and gathers data regarding the details of a population or situation without any intervention or manipulation, ensuring more authentic data. This research method was used to help the researchers deepen their understanding of the role of the Carahan Festival in strengthening the sense of cultural identity and community cohesion among the residents of Caramoan, Camarines Sur.

Population and Sampling

The focus of this study was to gather information surrounding the effects of the Carahan Festival in Caramoan, Camarines Sur, as a catalyst for strengthening the community's sense of identity, bonds, and cultural unity. With this, the research used simple random sampling.

The criteria for selecting the respondents are as follows: a. Must be a resident of Caramoan, Camarines Sur for at least five (5) years. b. May or may not be aware of the Carahan Festival. c. May or may not be a participant of the festival.

Data Collection Method

This study utilized a survey questionnaire prepared by the researchers for the respondents to answer. The interviews were conducted via Google Meet. The survey forms were divided into three sections. Included in the first section was the consent letter. The second part contained the questions for the respondents who are aware of the Carahan Festival. Lastly, the third section contained the questions for the respondents who are not aware of the Carahan Festival.

Argument

Data Analysis

Data collected through interviews and surveys were analyzed with the use of thematic analysis. The concept of this method is defined as a technique for locating, evaluating, and reporting themes or patterns in the data. Thematic analysis utilizes a six-step procedure, which includes: A) data familiarization; B) creation of initial codes; C) theme search; D) theme review; E) defining and identifying themes; and F) composing the study report (Georgiou Konstantinos, 2024). The results from this analysis were organized and categorized for further analysis and discussion.

Sampling Method

Simple random sampling guarantees that the population is impartial, representative, and equal in probability. This sampling method ensures that every person has an equal opportunity to take part in the study. In order to accurately represent the larger group, a smaller group is randomly selected (Noor, Tajik, and Golzar 2022).

The researchers requested the initial participants to recommend individuals who meet the study's requirements. The referral and survey process continued until 5 respondents had answered the questionnaire. The survey was disseminated and online through Facebook Messenger. Respondent participation in this study was voluntary.

Proofs

Results and Discussion

The collected data was reviewed thoroughly through repeated readings of transcripts from 18 respondents. Responses were categorized into two groups: aware respondents (1–16) and unaware respondents (17–18). The findings are presented below:

I. Data Familiarization

After reviewing the responses from all 18 participants, patterns and key points that emerged in their discussions about the Carahan Festival were identified. The aware respondents demonstrated a clear understanding of the festival's significance, while the unaware respondents expressed their desire for more exposure and information.

II. Creation of Initial Codes

The following initial codes were identified in the responses:

A. Aware Group:

a. Cultural significance

b. Community connection

c. Enjoyment and excitement

d. Barriers in promotion

e. Tourism opportunities

B. Unaware Group:

a. Lack of promotion

b. Insufficient education in schools

c. Interest in participation

d. Desire for cultural knowledge

III. Theme Search

The initial codes were grouped into broader themes:

A. Aware Group:

a. Cultural Pride and Community Connection - Reflects respondents' pride in the festival and its role in uniting the community.

b. Festival Enjoyment and Participation - Highlights the joy and memorable experiences tied to the festival.

c. Promotion Challenges - Points to gaps in advertising and outreach efforts.

B. Unaware Group:

a. Lack of Awareness and Education - Combines insufficient promotion and lack of cultural education.

b. Interest in Learning and Participating - Captures respondents' eagerness to learn about and engage in the festival.

IV. Theme Review

The initial themes were reviewed to ensure alignment with the data. Some overlaps were refined, such as merging "Insufficient education in schools" and "Lack of promotion" under "Lack of Awareness and Education". Themes were checked for consistency and relevance across responses.

V. Defining and Identifying Themes

The final themes and their definitions were established:

A. Cultural Pride and Community Connection - Celebrates the festival as a symbol of Caramoanon identity and a means of fostering unity.

B. Festival Enjoyment and Participation - Focuses on the vibrant experiences and active involvement of participants.

C. Promotion Challenges - Highlights the lack of effective advertising and its impact on festival reach.

D. Lack of Awareness and Education - Examines the disconnect among younger generations due to minimal promotion and absence of cultural education.

E. Interest in Learning and Participating - Captures the eagerness of the unaware group to engage with the festival.

VI. Composing the Study Report

A. Cultural Pride and Community Connection

Respondents shared how the Carahan Festival fosters a sense of identity and pride as Caramoanons. Many emphasized its role in uniting the community through shared traditions and celebrations. These sentiments underline the festival's cultural importance and its potential as a platform for community bonding.

B. Festival Enjoyment and Participation

The aware group frequently described the festival as a joyful experience filled with vibrant parades, contests, and cultural performances. These activities serve not only as entertainment but also as opportunities to showcase Caramoan's traditions and artistry.

C. Promotion Challenges

Both groups acknowledged gaps in promotion as a barrier to the festival's growth. Respondents noted that limited online presence, infrequent advertising, and the pandemic's impact contributed to reduced visibility. Suggestions included leveraging social media, producing engaging promotional materials, and targeting tourists.

D. Lack of Awareness and Education

The unaware group highlighted a critical issue: many younger residents are unfamiliar with the festival due to the absence of structured cultural education. Respondents suggested incorporating the festival's history and significance into school curricula to ensure its preservation.

E. Interest in Learning and Participating

Despite their lack of knowledge, the unaware group expressed strong interest in engaging with the festival if given the opportunity. This enthusiasm signals a potential for re-engagement and growth through targeted outreach and inclusive activities.

CHAPTER FOUR

Summary, Conclusions, and Recommendations

Recommendations

Based on the findings of this study on the Carahan Festival's impact on Caramoan culture and society, the following recommendations are proposed for future researchers:

1. **Broader Study Areas:** Future research should look into how the Isla Carahan Festival affects nearby communities, not just Caramoan. This could help understand how festivals in the Bicol region influence each other and contribute to the region's cultural identity.
2. **Long-Term Studies:** Future studies should track the Carahan Festival's impact over time to see how it affects local culture and community unity. This will help understand how its role changes with modern trends and social changes.
3. **Economic Impact:** Research should focus on how the festival boosts local businesses, tourism, and infrastructure. This will help find ways to grow the festival while keeping its cultural value intact.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the Carahan Festival significantly contributes to preserving local customs, fostering community involvement, and strengthening the collective sense of identity in Caramoan. Respondents emphasized its role in uniting the community through shared traditions, vibrant celebrations, and cultural pride. Participation in the festival creates a sense of belonging and strengthens community bonds while promoting enjoyment and cultural appreciation. However, challenges such as insufficient promotion and minimal cultural education were identified, particularly among younger generations, highlighting the need for improved outreach and integration of the festival's history into school curricula. Balancing modernization with cultural preservation is essential to ensure the festival remains a vital symbol of Caramoanon identity and heritage.

Appendix

Appendix A

Interview Questionnaire

The researchers will be conducting a research study entitled, "Honoring Heritage: The Carahan Festival's Impact on Caramoan Culture and Society." The study will be conducted by students enrolled in the subject SOCS102 N6 at Ateneo de Naga University, Naga City.

This study aims to assess the importance of the Carahan Festival in preserving cultural heritage, fostering community cohesion, and balancing modernization with the festival's authenticity. The findings of this research will contribute to the understanding of the festival's impact on cultural pride, social cohesion, and sustainable practices within the community of Caramoan, Camarines Sur.

Other relevant details are provided below:

1. Participants may choose to either send an audio recording of their responses to the interview questions or schedule an online interview, depending on their convenience.
2. In cases where interviews are conducted online, they will be held via Google Meet and recorded for documentation purposes. Audio recordings submitted by participants will also be stored securely for data analysis.
3. The participants will be asked about their experiences, perceptions, and opinions regarding the Carahan Festival and its role in the community.
4. Participation in the study is voluntary, and participants will not receive any monetary compensation or tokens.

5. There will be no costs associated with participation in the study.
6. The participants' personal information, such as names and addresses, will be collected only for tracking and research purposes during the data collection phase.
7. Access to the collected data will be restricted to the research team members involved in this study.
8. All collected data will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for academic purposes.

Written below will be the series of questions regarding the researchers' research topic:

A. Participants' Profile
   a. Name (Optional/Alias)
   b. Address (Barangay, Municipality)

B. Interview Proper

Questions for Aware:

1. Do you attend the Carahan Festival every year? Why or why not?

   Pumupunta ka ba sa Carahan Festival taon-taon? Bakit oo o bakit hindi?
2. How does participating in the Carahan Festival relate to your sense of identity?

   Paano nakakatulong ang paglahok mo sa Carahan Festival sa iyong pagkakakilanlan?
3. Do you feel proud of your culture when you join or watch the festival? Why?

   Nararamdaman mo bang ipinagmamalaki mo ang iyong kultura kapag sumasali o nanonood ka ng festival? Bakit?

4. Do you think joining local festivals makes you feel more part of your community? Why or why not?

   Sa tingin mo, nakakatulong ba ang pagsali sa mga lokal na pista para maramdaman mong bahagi ka ng inyong komunidad? Bakit oo o bakit hindi?

5. How has the role of digital tools like social media or live streaming affected the promotion and participation in the Isla Carahan Festival?

   Paano naapektuhan ng mga digital tools tulad ng social media o live streaming ang pagpapromote at paglahok sa Isla Carahan Festival?

Questions for Unaware:

1. If given the chance, would you like to participate in or learn more about the Carahan Festival? Why or why not?

   Kung bibigyan ka ng pagkakataon, gusto mo bang lumahok o matuto pa tungkol sa Carahan Festival? Bakit oo o bakit hindi?

2. Why do you think fewer people are becoming aware of the Carahan Festival?

   Bakit sa tingin mo mas kaunti na ang mga taong nagiging pamilyar sa Carahan Festival?

3. In your opinion, how does the lack of promotion affect people's declining interest in the festival?

   Sa tingin mo, paano nakakaapekto ang kakulangan ng promosyon sa pagbawas ng interes ng mga tao sa festival?

4. Do you think schools or organizations should promote local festivals to the younger generation? Why or why not?

   Sa tingin mo ba dapat i-promote ng mga paaralan o organisasyon ang mga lokal na festival sa kabataan? Bakit oo o bakit hindi?

5. Do you think joining local festivals makes you feel more part of your community? Why or why not?

   Sa tingin mo, nakakatulong ba ang pagsali sa mga lokal na pista para maramdaman mong bahagi ka ng inyong komunidad? Bakit oo o bakit hindi?

Appendix B

Transcriptions of Respondent Answers

Respondent 1 (Aware)

1. Bihira lng po ako pumunta sa caramoan festival. Most of the time kasama pamilya at mga kaibigan pero Di naman po kasi ako socially outgoing na tao kaya minsan minsan lng ako pumupunta po dun.
2. Para sa akin po nakakatulong yun festival na ipakita kung anong meron ang caramoan, since para sa akin po yun lugar po namin is di masyadong kilanlan sa camarines sur, Kaya pinapakita po nung festival na hey nandito po kaming mga taga caramoan meron din kaming mga magagandang yaman.
3. Although na minsan lng ako pumunta sa dun sa festival, Proud pa rin ako about dun. Sino ba naman ang di magiging proud sa kanilang heritage at pinagmulan.
4. Opo, sa pagattend ng festival sa tingin ko mas napapalapit ang mga tao dito. Ang mga panahon ng pyesta ay panahon ng tagsaya kaya parang nakatatak na na parte ka ng komunidad.
5. Sa tingin ko malaki ang positibong epekto ng mga digital tools gaya ng social media at live stream kasi di masyado kilanlan ang caramoan dito sa bicol. Sa pamamagitan ng social media at yung isa nagagawa nating ikalat ito ket sa malayong lugar. Kaya sa tingin ko nakakatulong ito sa tourism dito sa caramoan.

Respondent 2 (Aware)

1. Actually, I think two years man lang siyang na implement. So for the first two years, yes, naka attend ako, kasi by that time, my major is competition. So siyempre since majorette ako, required ako mag join for the competition. Pero on the second year, ang sinalihan ko na is pageant, Isla Carahan parin ito and nakua ko si title na miss Isla Carahan 2019 so I think yan si last kasi by 2020, ma na si festival.

2. Basically since first time magkaiwa ning registered festival for Caramoan, and unlike the previous fiesta, parang, I think nabuo si sense of identity ko bilang sarong Caramoanon kasi kumbaga naaraman ko kung ano si origin kang lugar, kang pangaran kung tano siya naging arog kayan. So basically, ako kumbaga, since na realize ko siya na ah ini palan si history kang name, kang lugar, kung tano siya arog kaini, and kung tano arog kaini ang apod sa mga tao or arug kaini dinedescribe ang mga tao sa Caramoan, like hospitable and all, kasi, basically, igwa siya ning origin, so parang mas naging mas makusog si sense of identity, ko sa Caramoan dabil sa festival na ito, pero yan sad to say na dae na siya napadagos.

3. Yes, I feel proud of my culture kasi yun na nga, na-araman ko na si etymology kan pangaran kan lugar, tapos bako lang dahil nagdadalan ako kundi dahil ako mismo si participant, so during the first and second year of implementation kan festival, part ako kato dae lang ako basta-basta like audience na nagdadalan lang, parte ako kato mismo, so despite na dae na sya napadagos, I can say na during the pioneering years of the festival,

saro ako duman sa naka experience first hand kan festival, kung ano si nasa laog katong buong activity and siyempre nga diba festival so siyempre garo ano naman kita like, nananali-nali kasi siyempre usually, ang familiar lang kita is Penafrancia festival so most of the time. pag, September, napa Naga, pa kita para mag attend ning festival. Kasi kita bilang mga taga Caramoan, ma kita ning sense of cultural identity through festival, dai ta yan naeexperience. Kumbaga ito nagtotown-fiesta kita, pero for what? For the sake of fiesta lang, for the sake na nagibo lang si town on that day. Pero dahil nagka-igwa ning festival garo naging mas deeper ang meaning kang pagcelebrate kang town fiesta and kang festival. So yan sana kuta mabalik siya.

4. Yes, pag part ka ng festival, iba ang feeling and iba rin yung feeling nang nag-jojoin ka lang kasi yun na ngani sabi ko kan inot, iba si feeling na na-eexperience mo firsthand kung ano si mga activity duman and parang garo naging lowkey bragging rights sya in a way kasi during the implementation of the festival, part ka kato and it will go down in history kasi kumbaga dahil dae na siya naulit as of now, ma-iistorya mo na naging part ka kang first and second year ning festival. So, mas nagkakaigwa ning sense of cultural identity or as a community kasi nga nasesense mo na garo "wow iyo palan ang feeling ning nag-aattend or iba man palan ang feeling ning nagpaparticipate" kasi mas ano sya, like the goosebumps feeling talaga na ohh nag level-up na kita, may festival na kita and part ka kato.

5. Actually during that time, parang kulang sa social media boosting kasi kumbaga parang mayo ning assigned na social media group or promotions group ang munisipyo. So in a way, kung na boost kuta to, most probably mas dakol pang ma-enjoy kato like ma-iinvite kita na mga tao, makakakua ning kadakol na sponsors. So basically dakula ang epekto kan social media kuta sa pag promote katong festival. Pero, because kan time na idto more on like pinopost siya, dae na ngani tanda kung hain na si mga pictures kaito mayo lamang or mga videos, mayong livestream before. Kumabaga garo naging part na lang siya ning history, naging istorya nalang siya. Mayo na si ano naimortalize kumbaga. So if only kan time na ito naboost si social media promotion, most probably dakol ma-eentized na mga tourists, na mga sponsors, gusto mag sponsor. Kasi ano sya like implementation siya and before the festival talagang siyempre bistado naman baga talaga ang Caramoan for the tourist attraction. Yan nga lang, nadadaog kita sa promotion sa social media kasi kumbaga dae ta naipapahiling kung pa talaga si mai-ooffer ta more than the tourist attraction itself. Kaya yan, grabe ang power kan social media.

Respondent 3 (Aware)

1. Yes, I've attended the Isla Carahan Festival every year from the moment it was launched in 2017 up until 2019. I've been part of the activities since I joined several events at that festival.
2. Well, some events are intended only for us like for example the Miss Cagayonan which I've joined twice and received major recognitions and that's also helped me more to empower myself as a part of the Trans Community and at the same time inspire other people that surrounds me.
3. I've always been proud of my identity as Caramoanon and as a member of the LGBTQ Community but it makes me more proud of being what I am and who I am as I joined the Festival before because the Isla Carahan is not just about the celebration of history, culture, and traditions, but it is a medium or a platform that helps every individual to know themselves and to better understand where they came from.
4. The Isla Carahan is not just about the celebration of history, culture, and traditions, but it is a medium or a platform that helps every individual to know themselves and to better understand where they came from.
5. Well, on the positive side, social media platforms help to promote the Isla Carahan Festival so that people around the globe may know how unique we Caramoanons are but, on the other hand, social media also has a bad impact cause as we all know nowadays anyone or everyone can do whatever they want, they can change the traditions of one's community because of adapting some foreign cultures that they saw on the internet and sometimes they have been forgotten who they are.

Respondent 4 (Aware)

1. I used to go to the Carahan Festival every year when I was in high school. Now that I'm in college, my school schedule often conflicts with the festival. Otherwise, I'm out of town for vacation. Because of that, I haven't been able to attend lately.
2. While I haven't fully experienced the entire events of the Carahan Festival, however, I still feel a strong connection to my Caramoan heritage through it. This festival is an important cultural tradition for me.
3. Watching or participating in the festival brings me a sense of pride in our culture. It's a celebration that highlights what makes us unique and special. Besides, it strengthens our community by bringing people together.
4. Yes. Local festivals will be a great way to allow me to be more part of a community. It will be an opportunity to know, understand, and connect with my fellows towards a shared cultural experiences.
5. Digital tools like social media and live streaming have really changed how we promote and participate in the Isla Carahan Festival. They allow more people to get involved and enjoy the event, even if they can't be there in person. This has significantly boosted interest and participation in the festival.

Respondent 5 (Aware)

1. Yes, I attend every year. I live in Caramoan, especially in Tawog where Isla Carahan events are organized.

2. It improves tourism, It also highlights the Caramoanons culture.
3. Yes, as a Caramoanon I feel proud because we share our culture, not just culture, we also share our hospitality to every person who visits Caramoan.
4. Yes, every person who attends a festival is a part of the event and community.
5. It promotes the Isla Carahan Festival easier than sharing it through talking, Social Media helps to show through the internet what events have the Isla Carahan Festival.

Respondent 6 (Aware)

1. Yes, I attend the Carahan Festival every year because as a Caramoanon participating in the festival give a sense of belongings that ties within the community and I am proudly represent the Caramoan especially the Carahan Festival that showcases the traditional dances, foods, and music of Caramoan.
2. Participating in the Carahan Festival relates to my senses through strengthening my connection to the community where I belong and to contributing to the preservation of our cultural heritage especially for the future generations.
3. Yes, I feel proud of my culture when i join or watch the festival because i witness the vibrant expressions of culture and tradition and it truly develop a sense of pride
4. in one's heritage and the community.
5. Yes, joining the local festivals makes me feel more part of my community because it will strengthen our cultural identity and connection to the community and because of having this kind of festival can attract more tourists to visit Caramoan that will also promote the tourism and economic development.

6. Because of the impact of the social media will help the promotion and participation in the Isla Carahan Festival because it wil allows the festival to attract and reach a wider audience. It will also enhance the accessibility for those people that cannot attend personally the festival by using live streaming so that they can attend virtually.

Respondent 7 (Aware)

1. Hindi taun-taon, dahil may pasok pa kami during ng pagdiriwang ng Carahan Festival. Ngunit sa tuwing ako ay walang pasok sinisiguro ko na ako ay makakadalo sa pagdiriwang na ito.
2. Ang pagsali sa Carahan festival ay nakakatulong sa akin na kumonekta sa ating komunidad at kultura.
3. Oo, ipinagmamalaki ko ang aking kultura kapag ako ay nanonood ng festival dahil ito ang nagpapaalala sa akin ng ating mga tradisyon.
4. Oo, nakakatulong ito dahil pinapagkaisa nito tayo at pinapagtibay ang ating koneksyon sa bawat isa.
5. Nakakatulong ang mga digital tools tulad ng social media o live streaming sa pag promote sa Isla Carahan Festival. Dahil mas napapadali at naabot ang mas maraming tao na kahit nasa malalayong lugar ay napapanood ito. Ito ay nagagawa sa pamamagitan ng online, kaya mas maraming sumusuporta dito.

Respondent 8 (Aware)

1. Oo, ito ay mahalaga samin dahil tradisyon namin ito at dahil tradisyon na ito ay nabibigyan kami ng pagkakataon upang makasama namin ang pamilya, kaibigan at member ng community para mag celebrate ng carahan festival.
2. Ang paglahok sa Carahan Festival ay nakakatulong sa akin na mas maunawaan at maipakita ang aking pagkakakilanlan bilang isang bahagi ng aming community.
3. Oo, kapag nanonood ako ng carahan festival dahil nakikita ko ang ibat ibat talento ng aking community, sobrang nagiging proud ako sa culture ko.
4. Oo, para mas makilala ko ang mga tao saming community.
5. Sobrang laking tulong ng social media at live streaming sa pagpapalaganap ng impormasyon tungkol sa Isla Carahan Festival. Dahil dito mas maraming tao, kabilang na ang mga nasa malalayong lugar, ang nagiging interesado at nakikilahok, kahit virtual man. Nagiging mas madali ring maipakita ang kagandahan ng festival sa mas malawak na audience.

Respondent 9 (Aware)

1. No. I don't know the date, and it needs improvement due to its lack of attractiveness.
2. Carahan is a part of culture it helps me to understand my homeland.
3. Yes, because it represent my homeland that makes myself being proud.
4. Yes, because it is how community being build by everyone else.
5. It shows different effect first is the lack of participation because of the emerging social media second the lack of support and lastly its ability to not being promoted by somebody

Respondent 10 (Aware)

1. Oo.
2. Sa pagiging supporta bilang isang parti Caramoanon.
3. Oo maganda manoud Kasi nakaka aliw.
4. Hindi.
5. Para sa mga Hindi maka kita sa personal pwedi lang Sila manoud sa Livestream Facebook page.

Respondent 11 (Aware)

1. No, I don't have the time to attend.
2. Participating in Carahan festival strengthens our identity by connecting us to our cultural heritage.
3. Yes, because of the pride that the festival gives.
4. Yes, It helps us to know more about our cultural heritage as it also helps us to connect to our community and traditions.
5. Digital tools like social media and live streaming helps the carahan festival to be known as it helps to promote and allowing people to share their experiences.

Respondent 12 (Aware)

1. Hindi masyado Ako nag attend Ng carahan festival, diko Kasi hilig na lumabas Ng bahay nakakanood lang kapag may mag aaya
2. Ang paglalahok sa carahan festival ay nakakatulong sa atin na mahubog ng ating communication skills at pakikisama.

3. Oo I feel proud Kasi dun makikita kung gaano kasaya Ang ating bayan, kung pano mag tulungan, kung pano makisama, Ang mga creativity Ng mga caramoanon ay lumalabas na lubos Kong maipagmamalaki.
4. Ang pag Sali sa mga lokal na pista ay nagbibigay talaga sa atin Ng pakiramdam na tayo ay belong tayo sa kumunidad, at dahil din Dito nalilinang natin Ang Sarili natin na mahalin pa Lalo Ang sariling kultura natin
5. Ang epekto Ng social media or live streaming is pwede Niya maipalawak or maibahagi sa iba na malalayo sa ating Lugar Ang ating kultura at Isa din to sa pwede tumulong para madaming tao Ang pwedeng bumisita sa Ganda Ng mga festival natin na kanilang ma enjoy Kasama Ang kanilang mga mahal sa Buhay.

Respondent 13 (Aware)

1. No, I used to attend the Carahan Festival every town fiesta. But sadly. I no longer do due to personal commitments or schedule conflicts, but I always stay updated on the events.
2. Participating in the Carahan enhances my sense of identity by reconnecting with the values cherished by my community. It serves as a celebration of who I am and where I come from.
3. Yes of course, as someone from Caramoan, I am proud of my hometown, and I also very proud of the festival it has. Seeing people come together to celebrate our history fills me with pride and joy. You can truly enjoy how happy everyone is as they celebrate the fiesta. You'll witness vibrant dancers emphasizing the turtle, which is where the Carahan Festival originates.

4. Joining local festivals makes me excited and you will see the unity. That makes the community more connected.
5. Digital tools like social media or livestream have significantly boosted awareness and involvement in the Isla Carahan Festival. They enable those unable to attend in person to still feel connected virtually. It can also attracting visitors from different areas especially in other countries.

Respondent 14 (Aware)

1. Yes, I attend the Carahan Festival every year since it is an important tradition because It's time to celebrate and connect with my heritage.
2. I feel a stronger sense of identity when I participate in the Carahan Festival where It strengthens my link with my ancestors and my community that rich cultural history.
3. Yes, I am quite proud of my culture during the event for the reason that the vibrant traditions and zest of others make me feel more attached to my roots.
4. Yes, going to local events like Carahan helps me connect more with my neighborhood that really offers the chance to interact with your neighbors and share a common experience.
5. Digital tools have significantly expanded the outreach of the Carahan Festival that's why social media and live streams allow people worldwide to experience the event and connect with our culture

Respondent 15 (Aware)

1. Yes. I've been going to the Isla Carahan Festival traditionally every year to reconnect and celebrate the abundance and beauty of our island.
2. My sense of identity is strengthened by taking part in the Isla Carahan Festival, which highlights my hometown's industrial and cultural heritage that helps me understand more about its historical roots.
3. Yes, each time I watch the celebration, I feel proud of my culture. Seeing the cultural customs being upheld and passed down to the next generation fills me with pride. In addition to providing entertainment, the festival's vibrant parades, dances, and other events educate and fortify the identity of our community.
4. Participating at local festivals helps me feel more connected. It introduces me to cultural traditions, develops relationships, and instills community pride. Additionally, sharing enjoyable experiences strengthens both my personal and communal bonds.
5. Digital tools like as social media and live streaming have considerably increased the Isla Carahan Festival's reach, allowed for real-time engagement, and promoted a sense of community among participants. They made the festival more accessible and entertaining for a larger audience.

Respondent 16 (Aware)

1. No, I do not attend the Carahan Festival every year because it is no longer celebrated. Although it was supposed to be an annual event, the festival has not been consistently held in recent years. This absence has left a significant gap in showcasing the cultural heritage, natural beauty, and industry of Caramoan Island. Unfortunately, political matters—though I won't elaborate much—seem to have played a role in its discontinuation. (Disclaimer lang po. The views and opinions expressed here do not necessarily reflect those of others in the community.)
2. As an active member of the community of course it connects me to the culture and traditions of Caramoan, strengthening my pride and sense of belonging.
3. The Isla Carahan Festival was first celebrated in 2017(if I'm not mistaken), and of course, I feel proud of my culture when I watched it. The festival showcases the unique traditions, natural beauty, and rich heritage of Caramoan. It's a celebration that brings the community together and highlights what makes our culture special and worth sharing with others.
4. As part of the LGBT+ community, yes, joining local festivals makes me feel more connected to my community. It creates a shared experience that brings people together through culture, traditions, and common values. As mentioned, being part of these celebrations fosters a sense of belonging, pride, and unity, and strengthens the bond between individuals and the community as a whole. It reminds me that everyone, regardless of background, plays an important role in the collective spirit of the community.

5. We are fortunate in this digital age because social media and live streaming have a great impact on the promotion and participation in the Isla Carahan Festival. These tools allowed the festival to reach a broader audience, both locally and globally, showcasing the unique traditions and beauty of Caramoan to people who might not be able to attend in person. However, it's unfortunate that the festival is no longer celebrated, leaving a gap in showcasing the culture and vibrancy of Caramoan.

Respondent 17 (Unaware)

1. Yes, I would love to participate in this festival all over again if there was still a chance.
2. First, because some people don't know that this festival existed especially the new generation of today's society. Their lack of knowledge about this Festival makes them unaware and leads them to not participate in the festival because they don't know there's this festival and the worst part of this is that it is not taught in school.
3. Their lack of knowledge about this Festival makes them unaware and leads them to not participate in the festival because they don't know there's this festival and the worst part of this is that it is not taught in school.
4. Yes, it is a must. Schools should teach the way of culture and tradition of Caramoan because this is our identity, same as we study our identity as Filipino citizens. We should not forget that. It is our duty and responsibility to preserve our cultural heritage and we must teach this and pass this on to the next generation.
5. Yes, joining local festival helps you feel connected to the community as it brings people to share history, tradition, and celebrate culture. it helps you feel like part of something larger than yourself.

Respondent 18 (Unaware)

1. If given the chance to learn more about Carahan Festival, of course I would be grateful to have the opportunity to know deeply about it and maybe join some activities too in the future. And the only reason I have in mind right now sa pag decide neto is that because I grew up there, I grew up in Caramoan, and I think I should be capable and be knowledgeable enough of what we celebrate and why we do it as part of our cultures and traditions.
2. One of the reason I could think of why fewer people are becoming unaware of it and not fond of it is the lack of promotion of the beautiful festival outside the municipality. In addition to this, as far as I remember, this was only started to be celebrated annually in a grand festive way where there are big street parades and everything only a few years back before the pandemic hit, at parang natigil or nawala na agad after nung pandemic. And even though there were annual pageants and basketball ligas and maybe also some small simple activities or contests for the people, bui think those were not appealing enough to be intentionally visited by tourists unlike the grandness of other festivals in other places.
3. Promotion has the biggest role in this kind of activities. Kasi knowing na medjo maliit lang ang Caramoan at syempre ang population neto, talagang hindi matatangkilik na enough ang lahat na pinaghihirapan na iprepare ng mga tao kung walang promotion na magaganap outside Caramoan. In my past experiences din, there are only a few promotional publications and videos that are appealing online na dapat sana ay kukuha ng interest at attention ng mga tao. And yan, kaya napakalaki talaga ng role ng efficient at effective na promotional strategies ng lugar para makuha ang interes ng mga tao.

4. Yes definitely schools and organizations should promote these festivities lalo na sa younger generations kasi this is a big part of our culture as Caramoanons. I may not have enough knowledge about our festival as of this time but I would really advocate having a particular activity na talagang hindi lang malalaman ng kabataan kung ano yung Carahan Festival but also be able to participate dito, magsaya, at ipagpatuloy at ikwento sa iba yung magandang experience na makukuha nila. Kasi in this way, the Carahan Festival would continue to live on and receive the recognition that it deserves.
5. Oo naman! Kasi aside from the lifelong experiences and learnings na tatatak saakin, sa pamamagitan nito, mas masasabi ko rin na ako ay isang Proud na Caramoanon. And in addition to this, I think it is time for me to give back to the beautiful community where I grew up with these simple ways like participating sa festivals, promoting it to other places, and even sa ganitong paraan na kahit hindi ko man fully naeexperience yung festival ay nakakapagbigay parin ako ng insights na maaaring makatulong. Kasi nga as I have mentioned earlier, Carahan Festival is also a beautiful festival that deserves more recognition lalong-lalo na para sa mga tao behind it na talagang nageeffort para maging maganda at maenjoy ng lahat yung festival.

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